

UNE FAIBLE IMPRESSION — Shot List Braindump

Une Faible Impression (*A Faint Impression*) · Rev. 1.3 · Chowdhury & Zaman

No-computer session · 2026-08-13

8 scenes · 23 beats

Star (★) must-haves · Circle favorites

SIZE — WS wide · MS medium · MCU med-close · CU close · ECU extreme close · 2S two-shot · INS insert

ANGLE/MOVE — OTS over-shoulder · POV · HA/LA high/low angle · STAT static · HH handheld · DOLLY · PAN · TILT · TRACK

SCENE 1 **EXT. PARK BENCH — SUNRISE**

1A · Letter, three tries

MAN sits on a bench, sun rising behind him, ignored. Picks up NOTEBOOK and PEN.

MAN (V.O.)

Chère Maman... Je pense à toi. (Dear Mom... I miss you.)

Unsatisfied, scratches it out. Exhales,
starts again.

MAN (V.O.)

Chère Maman... Je réfléchissais à l'idée
de marche en avant... (...*thinking about
progress... reminded me of our train ride
from Toulouse to... I can't remember
where...*)

Still unsatisfied, scratches out again.
Final breath.

MAN (V.O.)

Maman... Que voulais-tu dire quand tu as dit: «Il faut entendre le mot avec la résonance du monde.» ...parce que le mot- (...*What did you mean: "hear the word with the sound of the world"... because the word-*)

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

1B · The lost word / WOMAN appears

MAN forgets the French word for "beckon."

WOMAN (O.S.)

Appelle... [repeats 3x: MAN doesn't notice, then searches for the source, then goes back to his notebook]

MAN remembers: Appelle. Begins writing. A WOMAN, early 30s, is seated on a parallel bench.

MAN (V.O.)

Le mot m'appelle loin du confort... (*The word beckons me away from comfort...*)

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

1C · "Come here often?"

WOMAN
Come here often?

MAN *(surprised)*
Huh?

WOMAN *(louder)*
Do you come here often?

MAN
Ah... yes. In the mornings, you?

WOMAN *(smiles)*
Wouldn't you know, if you come here often?

MAN *(smiles back)*
Not with certainty.

WOMAN
Just passing through. Duluth. Keokuck.
Now... as good a stop as any, wouldn't you say?

MAN
Why?

WOMAN gestures toward the landscape with her eyes.

MAN
Why are you passing through?

WOMAN prepares a big anecdote.

MAN *(cuts her off)*
What are you reading?

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

1D · Book & Map

WOMAN
Oh, Pushkin.
Holds up the BOOK — a worn Eugene Onegin.

MAN
In Russian?

WOMAN
No, translation.

MAN *(disinterested)*
Oh.
MAN returns to NOTEBOOK. WOMAN pulls out a folded MAP.

WOMAN
Would you happen to know the way out?

MAN
Straight down. Take a right at the sycamore by the bend. Then you'll hit the main road.

WOMAN
What does a sycamore look like?

MAN
If you have gone too far, you'll know.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

1E · Cigarette / wind / paper flies

MAN closes NOTEBOOK, stands, lights a CIGARETTE. WOMAN folds the map, returns to her book.

WOMAN (*while reading*)

If it's not translatable, why do we bother?

MAN (defeated)

Hmm... Feeble meaning is better than nothing at all.

A gust of wind through the trees. Both surprised.

WOMAN

Is it a poem?

MAN

Something like that. [Laughs] It doesn't rhyme.

WOMAN stands, looks into the distance.

Stronger gust - MAN's SHEET OF PAPER flies away, twisting in the air. MAN chases it.

WOMAN

Hah... He has a very rebellious turn of mind...

WOMAN slowly follows. MAN picks up the fallen PAPER.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

SCENE 1 NOTES — master / coverage / transitions

SCENE 2 EXT. WOODS/FOREST — DAYTIME

2A · BOY, alone

A young BOY, 7, picks up some soil. He thinks he hears his name and turns toward it. What is its source?

Slowly, he walks. Is he being pulled, or is he searching?

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

SCENE 2 NOTES — master / coverage / transitions

SCENE 3 EXT. PARK ROAD — MOMENTS LATER**3A · Train story / "I misspoke"**

MAN and WOMAN walk the road. MAN puts his LIGHTER in his pocket.

WOMAN (*comfortable, smoking*)

On my way up from Ste. Genevieve, train got delayed... because of another train... Man behind me gets a call from his wife... She's angry because surely he is cheating again... Hah...

MAN

You said you came from Keokuck...

WOMAN

I misspoke...

They walk in silence.

WOMAN (*cont.*)

The train stops half a mile too far. He passes her house on the train... to get to her house...

MAN

Feels like fate, no?

WOMAN

I am indifferent to fate.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

3B · Half-mile home / small beauty

MAN

A half-mile walk isn't too far, if it takes you home.

WOMAN

Every time I go home, this tiredness overcomes me...

MAN and WOMAN look up. They notice a small beauty. Is it a tree? A bird?

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

SCENE 3 NOTES — master / coverage / transitions

SCENE 4 EXT. WOODS — MOMENTS LATER**4A · BOY in the woods / VO over image**

BOY navigates through the woods, cuts through bushes and trees, arrives at an opening.

WOMAN (*V.O.*)

It's so beautiful that you think you discovered it...

MAN (*V.O.*)

And if we didn't?

WOMAN (*V.O.*)

But... it feels like the beginning of a process, rather than an end in itself...

MAN (*V.O.*)

Oh, beauty... [Pause] The blindness to which it gave rise... If only we could see.

WOMAN (*V.O.*)

What would we see?

MAN (*V.O.*)

We would see straight away that something is true, and something is false.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

SCENE 4 NOTES — master / coverage / transitions

SCENE 5 EXT. BOLLARD AREA/PARK — MOMENTS LATER**5A · Cigarette / stay another day**

MAN and WOMAN weave through a set of bollards.

MAN
Cigarette?

WOMAN
No...
Man lights one more CIGARETTE for himself.

MAN
When do you leave?

WOMAN
Soon.

MAN
Stay another day. See the city.

WOMAN
No...

MAN
What's the hurry?
MAN and WOMAN sit on bollards.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

5B · Breath / two sunrises / L'avenir

WOMAN
Time... Maybe on a cooler, quieter day, I would have said yes...

MAN blows into the air — you can see his breath. Is it not cool enough? WOMAN smiles.

MAN
It takes two sunrises to know this town...

WOMAN
L'avenir nous prend les bras... Or something. *(The future seizes us by the arms — misspoken; she meant "L'avenir nous tend les bras/The future awaits us...")*
MAN is shaken by the phrase. He stops, trying to understand.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

5C · Wedding / Guatemala

WOMAN *(cont.)*
Besides, I can't disappear. I'm to be wed in a month. Some altar requires my presence.

MAN
Oh, congratulations. Where's your—

WOMAN
Guatemala.

MAN
What for?

WOMAN
Digging wells.

MAN
Oh, commendable.

WOMAN
It's what drew me to him.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

5D · Separation / different memories

WOMAN stands, takes a few steps.

MAN

And how do you manage the separation?

WOMAN walks back, sits on a closer bollard.

WOMAN

I don't think about that. [Pauses] To remember one thing while excluding everything else is a separation in itself.

MAN

Still it must be...

WOMAN

From time to time... And from time to time he sends me photos of water systems and children with strange-shaped hats.

MAN gets up and walks away. WOMAN follows.

MAN

But you're creating different memories...

WOMAN

All memories are an invention of repression.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

5E · Daydream / Eden / memory

They walk in silence.

WOMAN *(cont.)*

Human consciousness is oriented towards what hasn't arrived... You cannot live without daydreaming...

MAN

I think there is another way...

WOMAN

Those who can dream of the Garden of Eden are-

MAN *(cuts her off)*

Eden is a memory...

WOMAN

To not dream means to die. And it's never easy to die.

MAN

You cannot live without memory... It's never easy to die.

WOMAN

Feel that?

MAN

What?

WOMAN

A hint of hatred dwells in that belief... [Pause] The heart's memory eliminates the bad and magnifies the good. The mind's is quite the opposite. Either way, it's catering to first-world issues through a first-world lens...

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

5F · Bourgeois / language / "read me"

MAN

Tell me more.

WOMAN

The past. It's a Bourgeois self-interest... And it likes to draw all other interest into its own failure...

MAN

Bourgeois?

MAN looks down at his clothes.

WOMAN

My words poorly portray my thoughts...

MAN

Everything first sneaks in through language. Action comes later... Read me from your book.

WOMAN reads from book. (Insert passage)

MAN

I doubt you ever even notice when the
skies change from day to night...

WOMAN

Hah... How can you tell?

MAN

The way you read...

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

5G · Jacket / genealogy

WOMAN puts the book in her jacket pocket...

MAN

A beautiful jacket...

WOMAN

It was my mother's...

MAN

It reeks of genealogy... [Pause] The best color for a jacket... and for the leaves...

MAN walks away.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

SCENE 5 NOTES — master / coverage / transitions (longest scene — consider a coverage pattern to reuse across beats)

SCENE 6 EXT. WOODS — CONTINUOUS

6A · BOY finds the bed/manger

BOY walks through the opening and sees a
BED/MANGER in the middle of the woods.
He slowly makes his way to it. He runs his
hand over the sheets. He gets on.
He starts jumping. Slowly, then faster.
He starts to turn. Suddenly, he stops. He
sees something. Tears well in his eyes.
A woman is standing in the distance.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

SCENE 6 NOTES — master / coverage / transitions

SCENE 7 EXT. LOVER'S LEAP/PARK — MOMENTS LATER**7A · Translation / what is lost**

MAN and WOMAN sit on a ledge. WOMAN reads from her book, pauses.

WOMAN

So you hate translations?

MAN

I don't hate them. In fact, I succumb to them.

WOMAN

But nothing can ever be transmitted in its entirety. Always a filtered remainder.

MAN

So, what is lost?

WOMAN

It's lost on me now. But, we can't help ourselves.

MAN

And why not?

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

7B · Preservation / twisted words / language as filter

WOMAN contemplates.

MAN (mockingly)

Ah, so for preservation?

WOMAN

You twist my words.

MAN

You twist your own words! Language itself is a filtering of its own.

WOMAN

Language is just a mode of communication.

MAN

Yes, but not poetry. [Pause] Communication transmits what is already known. But what about the unknown? [Pause] What about the moment when something within the human being becomes too complete, too charged, too coherent to remain unexpressed... and therefore must take shape in the world?

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

7C · "A becoming?"

WOMAN (mockingly)

Oh, so a becoming?

MAN

You complicate the solution much beyond the problem itself... A poem makes you feel that something was felt. Expression is its arrival.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

7D · Futural / elegiac / presence of absence

WOMAN

Beauty is futural in action.

MAN

It is elegaic in substance.

Sit in silence.

MAN

If it is both, then perhaps it can never be perceived.

WOMAN

Beauty isn't a prisoner of perception.
It's the master of it, and in that sense,
beauty is simply presence.

MAN

And what about the presence of absence? I find that incredibly beautiful.

WOMAN

You must have your reasons.

MAN chuckles.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

7E · Measured vs. felt / one with Nature

WOMAN

Some want time measured out. Some want it felt.

Sit in silence, deadlocked. This time, Nature remains silent too. Instead, the trees, the skies, beauty itself, listen in. MAN and WOMAN are one with Nature.

WOMAN

How old are the trees? The skies?

MAN

And the wind?

WOMAN

It's hard to say.

MAN

It's hard to know.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

SCENE 7 NOTES — master / coverage / transitions

SCENE 8 **EXT. WOODS — CONTINUOUS**

8A · Final image

WOMAN, now old, stands in the forest. She looks somberly into the distance.

#	SIZE	ANGLE/MOVE	LENS	NOTES

SCENE 8 NOTES — master / coverage / transitions